

General Guidelines for Reimbursement of Travel Expenses for Overseas Academic Activities in Scientific Research Projects (V2.1)

To standardize the reimbursement process for travel expenses related to overseas research activities and ensure the compliant use of funds, this guideline is hereby established in accordance with the “Guidelines for Management of Research Funding at U.S. Higher Education Institutions (2023 Edition)” and our institution’s financial regulations. This guideline applies to overseas travel expenses incurred under the guise of academic conferences, joint research projects, international collaborations, and similar activities.

I. Definition of Reimbursement Expenses

Accommodation expenses: Refers to the actual overnight accommodation costs incurred in the city where the conference is held, including but not limited to room charges, dining service fees within the hotel, parking fees, internet usage fees, and other ancillary expenses directly related to accommodation. The above-mentioned expenses shall be combined into a single total accommodation expenditure and may not be reported separately.

Transportation costs: Includes round-trip international airfare, as well as taxi or ride-hailing fees from the local airport to your accommodation/conference venue;

Conference registration fee: Only registration fees paid through official channels and for which an electronic or paper receipt has been obtained are eligible.

Food and Miscellaneous Expenses: These will be handled on a daily fixed-amount lump-sum basis and will not be reimbursed individually by receipt (this guideline does not specify exact amounts; implementation shall follow the annual budget notice).

II. Reimbursement Process

1. **Submission of Materials:** The applicant shall prepare a complete reimbursement package (including original receipts, supporting documentation, and a detailed expense breakdown), upload the electronic version through the financial system, and submit a hard copy.
2. **Department Review:** The project leader reviews the authenticity of the itinerary and the relevance of the tasks, then signs their opinion.
3. **Financial Review:** The Finance Department verifies the compliance of vouchers (including invoice type, consistency of time and location, and logical accuracy of amounts) and the completeness of supporting documents.

4. Reimbursement receipt: After the review is approved, the funds will be transferred to the applicant's designated bank account within 10 business days (supporting ACH transfers or international wire transfers).

III. Requirements for Bill Information

The ticket must specify the time of occurrence and the location where the service was provided (accurate to the city level, e.g., "San Diego, CA");

The invoice must not be handwritten; machine-printed invoices, electronic statements (PDF), and credit card statement summaries (including Merchant ID and Transaction ID) are acceptable.

Non-essential information such as hotel name, room number, and detailed consumption items is contained within the receipt itself and is not reflected in the background documents.

IV. Requirements for Reimbursement by Multiple People

If a single accommodation booking involves multiple people (e.g., sharing a room), the reimbursement amount will be the sum of each individual's share.

Shared expenses for catering, transportation, and other services can be reported cumulatively, provided that the participating personnel and the reason for the expenses are clearly indicated.

V. List of Authenticity Verification Materials

Conference invitation or registration confirmation email (including the attendee's name, conference date, and location);

Excerpt from the project proposal or task description (to demonstrate task relevance);

Itinerary approval form (including signature/electronic signature);

Travel work records (such as meeting minutes, on-site photos with timestamp watermarks, etc.; not mandatory but recommended to provide).

VI. Types of Reimbursable Receipts (in compliance with U.S. tax practices)

Electronic receipts issued by merchants eligible for IRS Form 1099-K (including Merchant ID, Transaction ID, date, and amount);

Official PDF invoice from the hotel/rental car company (including Folio Number, VAT/Tax ID, and Payment Method);

Credit card monthly statement summary page (clearly showing Transaction ID, Date, Amount, and Merchant Name);

Not accepted: Handwritten receipts, WeChat/Alipay screenshots, merchant slips without tax IDs, and blurry or unclear images.

This standard shall take effect as of January 1, 2024, and the authority to interpret it rests with the Finance and Research Management Department of this institution.

Finance and Research Management Department

May 30, 2024